

Piter Garcia
1 Trails Edge Drive, Unit 105
West Henrietta, NY 14586
pzg8794@rit.edu

March 31, 2025

Members of the Warner School Admissions Committee
Warner School of Education
University of Rochester

Dear Members of the Warner School Admissions Committee,

I am writing to express my enthusiastic application for the Master's in Teaching program with Initial Certification in K-12 Computer Science at the Warner School of Education. I am particularly excited about the opportunity to pursue this program through the Noyce Scholarship, which aligns closely with my passion for computer science education and my commitment to teaching in high-need schools.

I hold a Master's degree in Computer Science from Rochester Institute of Technology, as well as a Bachelor's degree in Computer Engineering from Farmingdale State College. Additionally, I am currently completing a Master's program in Data Science at RIT, which serves as a bridging program to enhance my research skills and prepare for a future PhD. I have two semesters remaining in this program. However, my immediate focus is on finding effective ways to make a positive impact in high-need schools as quickly as possible, by leveraging the resources and mentorship provided through the Noyce Scholarship program.

My professional journey since graduation has included roles in data science, software engineering, interdisciplinary research, and tutoring. While these experiences strengthened my technical expertise, they also confirmed my desire to create a positive impact through teaching. Working as a tutor with Varsity Tutors, mentoring students in various STEM disciplines, deepened my commitment to creating equitable learning opportunities and fostering an inclusive environment where all students can thrive. I firmly believe that teaching K-12 Computer Science can inspire students to embrace critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving skills that are essential in today's technology-driven world. This realization has motivated me to pursue a career where I can directly empower students in high-need schools, fostering critical thinking and creating opportunities where they are most needed.

The Warner School's commitment to preparing educators to effectively implement the New York State Computer Science and Digital Fluency standards resonates with my own aspirations. I am excited by the prospect of developing the skills and pedagogical knowledge necessary to foster inclusive and effective

computer science education within high-need schools. The additional coursework and mentorship opportunities offered by the Noyce Scholarship will be invaluable as I work toward becoming a dedicated and impactful educator.

Furthermore, I am eager to fulfill the Noyce Scholarship's requirement of teaching in a high-need school for at least two years within four years of graduating from the program. I view this commitment not only as a scholarship obligation but as a personal mission to make a meaningful difference where it is most needed.

Thank you very much for considering my application. I look forward to the possibility of joining the Warner School community and contributing to the Noyce Scholarship's vision of preparing the next generation of STEM educators.

Sincerely,

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Members of the Warner School Admissions Committee
Warner School of Education
University of Rochester

Dear Members of the Warner School Admissions Committee,

I am excited to apply for the EdD program in Teaching and Curriculum with Initial Certification in K-12 Computer Science at the Warner School of Education. I am particularly drawn to the "Leadership in Disability and Inclusive Practices" opportunity, which also aligns with my passion for computer science education and commitment to teaching in high-need schools.

I hold a Master's degree in Computer Science from RIT and a Bachelor's degree in Computer Engineering from Farmingdale State College. Currently, I am completing a Data Science Master's at RIT to enhance my research skills for a future PhD. My immediate goal is to make a positive impact in high-need schools through mentorship and resources from respected programs.

My professional journey centers on applying computer science in teaching and software development to enhance learning and healthcare. At Viome and Veda-Data, I developed systems for improved data management and diagnostics. As a tutor with Varsity Tutors, I've mentored students in advanced topics such as Algorithms, C++, Data Structures, Java, Python, and SQL. These experiences have strengthened my commitment to creating equitable learning environments, empowering students, and contributing meaningfully to healthcare through innovative computer science solutions.

The Warner School's commitment to preparing educators to effectively implement the New York State Computer Science and Digital Fluency standards resonates with my own aspirations. I am particularly interested in pursuing the K-12 Digitally Rich Certificate while exploring the Leadership in Disability and Inclusive Practices Certificate to broaden my skills and impact. These additional programs align well with my desire to enhance accessibility, promote inclusivity, and empower both students and fellow educators.

My post-graduation plan involves leveraging the Warner School's resources and network to establish a venture that uses Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Data Mining (DM) to tackle **learning and healthcare challenges**. The Warner School's dedication to cutting-edge research, interdisciplinary collaboration, and

mentorship aligns well with my goals. As a doctoral student, I aim to contribute to the Warner School by applying my expertise in Computer Science, particularly AI and Data Mining. I look forward to collaborating with faculty, mentoring students in advanced topics, participating in curriculum development, fostering a dynamic learning environment, and ensuring students are equipped with practical, forward-thinking skills.

Additionally, I aim to enrich the Warner School's research community with insights shaped by overcoming a chronic illness and my recent ADHD diagnosis. These experiences drive my commitment to developing inclusive learning tools, advancing medical diagnostics, and bridging technology with accessibility. I am particularly interested in scalable computational solutions that enhance healthcare and learning accessibility, including tools for individuals with learning differences like ADHD.

Over the next five years, I plan to:

First Year: Immerse in Warner School's teaching, assist in Computer and Data Science courses, mentor students, and participate in workshops and seminars.

Second and Third Years: Develop AI tools, refine teaching techniques, and contribute to curriculum development for a rigorous and inclusive education.

Fourth Year: Apply research practically by partnering with industry collaborators, developing deployable solutions that demonstrate real-world impact.

Fifth Year: Complete my dissertation, establish sustainable research initiatives, and mentor students, particularly those with learning differences.

The resources, mentorship, and collaborative environment at the Warner School will be invaluable in achieving my goals. I am excited about the opportunity to learn from and contribute to the distinguished faculty and vibrant research community. I look forward to enhancing the Computer Science program through dedicated research, teaching, and practical innovation.

Thank you for considering my application. I am eager to join the Warner School community and contribute to its vision of preparing the next generation of impactful leaders in education.

Sincerely,

Piter Garcia